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People and Earth's Environment

Dig for GOLD, BUT don't let rivers run COLD

Mining in Mindanao and the Davao region has long been associated with river corrosion, sedimentation and chemical discharge. This slogan clearly shows the trade-off: rivers pay the price for our mining wealth pursuit. The phrase "Rivers run cold" is a literal statement about rivers losing their warm, living environment, but it is also a warning that nothing is sustained by cold, dead water.

The slogan's deeper meaning is the contrast of caring and greed. Gold symbolizes not just real mining, but the wider urge to mine at all costs, including business profit, economic progress and development. Rivers, however, are life itself. They bring towns clean drinking water, fish to diners, and water to fields. By letting them "run cold", we let communities quietly die out, generation after generation. The words "gold" and "cold" rhyme intentionally, because they are related. One always threatens the existence of the other.

Mining is so vital to Mindanao that I decided to investigate it. The Davao River system and its neighboring rivers in Davao del Norte, Compostela Valley and adjacent areas are directly affected by large-scale mining operations. The farmers downstream see it first: the muddy irrigation water, the falling fish populations, the unusually rare flooding. The youth of these communities should have access to the rivers for drinking, swimming and fishing. This phrase is a call to arms: before any drill ever hits the ground, demand ethical mining, open environmental impact assessments, and real community consent.